UPFRONT

ECO WATCH: HISS HISS HURRAY *PG 15*

GRAPHIC: A WAR ON DELHI STRAYS *PG 16*











▶ OPERATION SINDOOR

AFTERBURNER EFFECT

Three months after striking deep inside Pakistan, the IAF reveals a few surprises in its kill tally—raising questions about timing, politics and narrative control

By PRADIP R. SAGAR

THREE MONTHS AFTER THE GUNS FELL SILENT, the head of the Indian Air Force finally spoke. At the 16th edition of the Air Chief Marshal L.M. Katre Memorial Lecture in Bengaluru on August 9, the incumbent, A.P. Singh, broke months of speculation with a blunt averment: that Operation Sindoor had taken out at least six Pakistani warplanes in the air—five fighter jets and "one large aircraft"—and crippled key military installations deep